



Interiority as Lived Continuity: Why Experience Feels Like Something



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Interiority as Lived Continuity answers the question of why experience feels like something from the side of lived time. Drawing on Husserl’s analysis of internal time-consciousness, Heidegger’s account of care and temporality, and Merleau-Ponty’s account of embodied skill, it locates interiority within a continuity that carries the past forward while participating in future possibilities. Experience is the interior aspect of a coherent continuity carrying itself forward through time.

Why experience feels like something

Why does experience feel like something?

How it works

1. **Interiority arises within continuity.** Interiority arises within a continuity that carries the past forward while participating in future possibilities.
2. **One structure across many capacities.** Memory, anticipation, skill, care, and recognition reveal a common structure in which what has been and what is becoming remain active within the present.
3. **Coherence makes continuity experiential.** Continuity becomes experiential when it acquires sufficient coherence to sustain and organize its own activity through time.
4. **The continuity becomes present to itself.** As a life develops increasingly stable relationships among memory, anticipation, recognition, and action, the continuity becomes increasingly present within its own ongoing development.
5. **The self emerges in the process.** The familiar feeling of being a self emerges within this lived process.
6. **Experience is the interior aspect of continuity.** Experience is the interior aspect of a coherent continuity carrying itself forward through time.

Terms to know

- **Interiority.** The inside of a continuity that carries its past forward while participating in its future possibilities.
- **Lived continuity.** A life’s ongoing carrying forward of what has been into what is becoming.
- **Coherence.** Enough organization for a continuity to sustain and organize its own activity through time.

Sources it draws on

- **Husserl:** the analysis of internal time-consciousness.
- **Heidegger:** the account of care and temporality.
- **Merleau-Ponty:** the account of embodied skill.

Together these three supply the phenomenological ground for the common structure above: memory, anticipation, skill, care, and recognition, each holding what has been and what is becoming active within the present.

What it reveals

By locating interiority within the dynamic organization of lived time, the paper gives a phenomenological response to the question of why experience feels like something at all.

The bigger picture

This is the second step seen from lived experience. Memory is inherited organization still available from earlier experience, and anticipation is inherited organization already directed toward what comes next.

Full paper on PhilArchive: [Interiority as Lived Continuity: Why Experience Feels Like Something](#)

Before this: [Continuity as an Organizing Variable](#).

Next: [Where Time Concentrates: The Traffic Light Analogy](#), a picture of how many histories gather into one present.

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Consequential history is the past still acting, carried forward to the active boundary where it meets what arrives. Consciousness is access to consequential history. AHQ is the experienced threshold crossing, the click of insight.

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